presumably lived. It is enclosed in thick fortification walls of stone, with pillared guard rooms just inside the locking gates, as in medieval forts. To the north of the citadel is the middle town, and the lower town is to its east. The middle town had larger homes and an enclosing wall of its own, suggesting that people of a higher class lived there than in the lower town, who were protected only by the outer city walls.

The massive walls of the citadel has towers and five gates, each with a different design. Inside, there are remains of a ‘castle’, with its concealed passageways; sewage and water harvesting drains; stairs and chambers, some with chiselled pillars of finely polished limestone. East of the castle on the citadel is the ‘bailey’ area, with homes of people presumed to be servants to those in the castle and perhaps also granaries (some dispute this interpretation). Many of the seven settlement stages, which span a depth of 14 metres, are visible in certain excavated parts of the citadel, though most stages lie buried. What’s visible today doesn’t always correspond with the city’s mature phase. Overall, less than a fifth of the site has been excavated.

Among the most impressive finds on the citadel are its intricate network of storm-water drains, ‘with slopes, steps, cascades, manholes (air ducts/water relief ducts), paved flooring and capstones’.[12] Its arterial drain was large enough for a person to walk through. A deep well atop the citadel was once fitted with ropes and leather buckets—a stone at the edge has rope marks—and the extracted water then cascaded down rock-lined channels to a small water reservoir, and to a bathing tank for the citadel’s residents. Who occupied this privileged spot, and what social organization supported them? All we have now is informed speculation (more on this below).

Both the middle and lower towns functioned as residential quarters, with streets and homes laid out on an approximate grid-like plan. Many bead and metal workshops have also been found, suggesting that these areas were not only residential. Among other trades, the locals cut, polished, etched, and drilled beads with high artistic and technological skill. Many homes seem to combine a workshop area, a washroom and residential quarters. As with most ancient cities, the rooms, even in the middle town, are small by today’s middle-class urban standards— they’re more like the rooms in our urban slums. Kitchens seem scarce, suggesting the use of communal kitchens. In the first three stages of the city, people used white and pink